



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt,
Gnóthaí Baile agus Imirce
Department of Justice,
Home Affairs and Migration

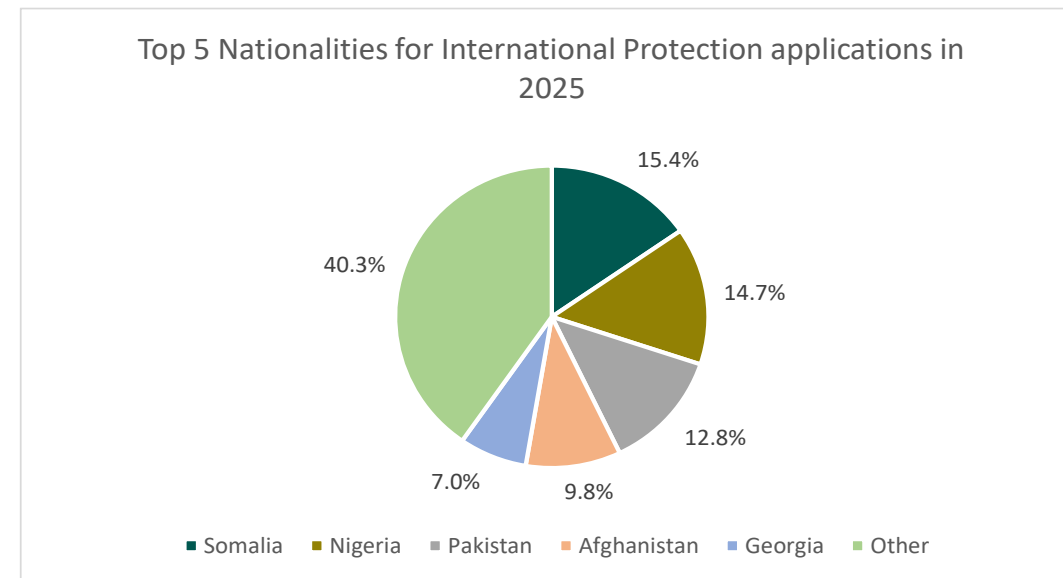
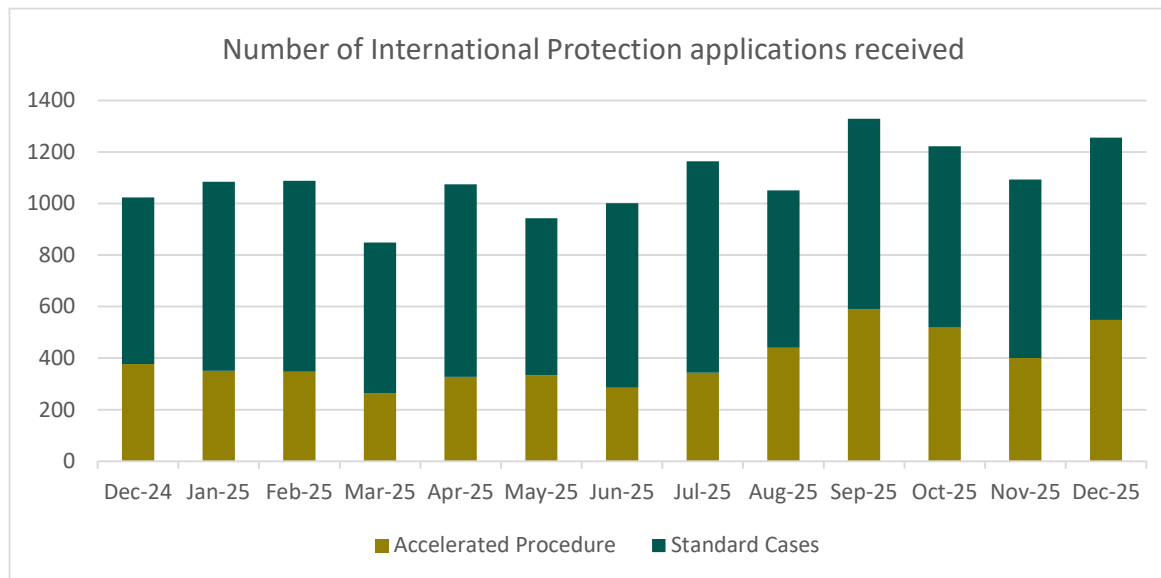
International Protection: December 2025

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 6th January 2026. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for December 2025:

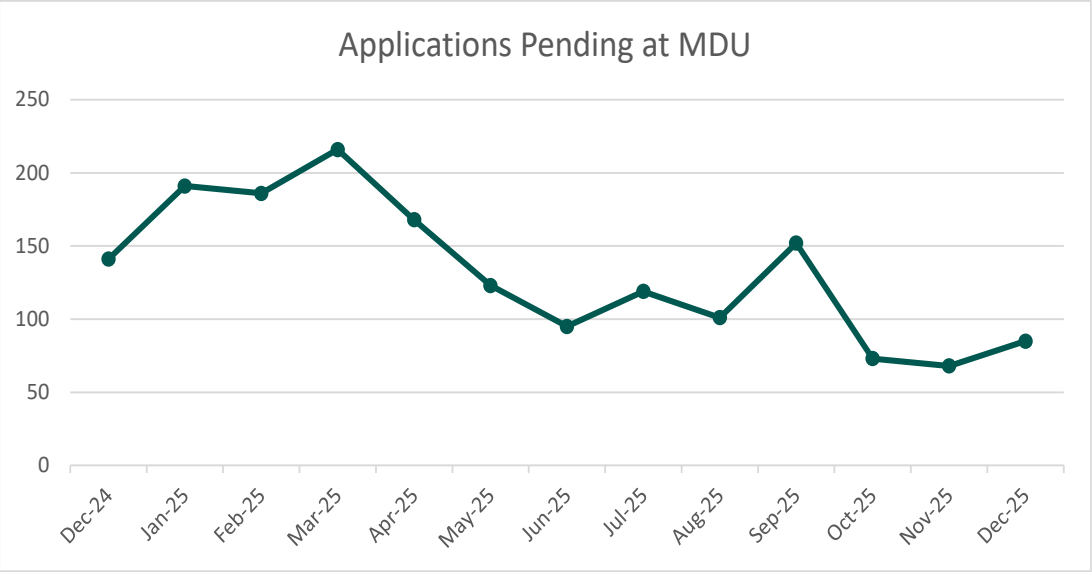
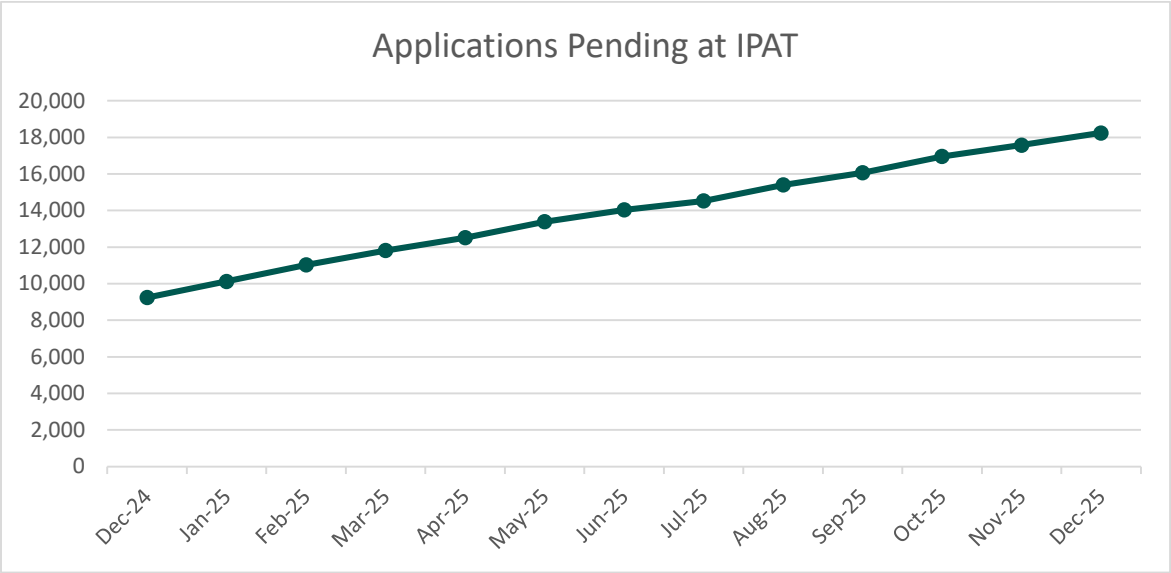
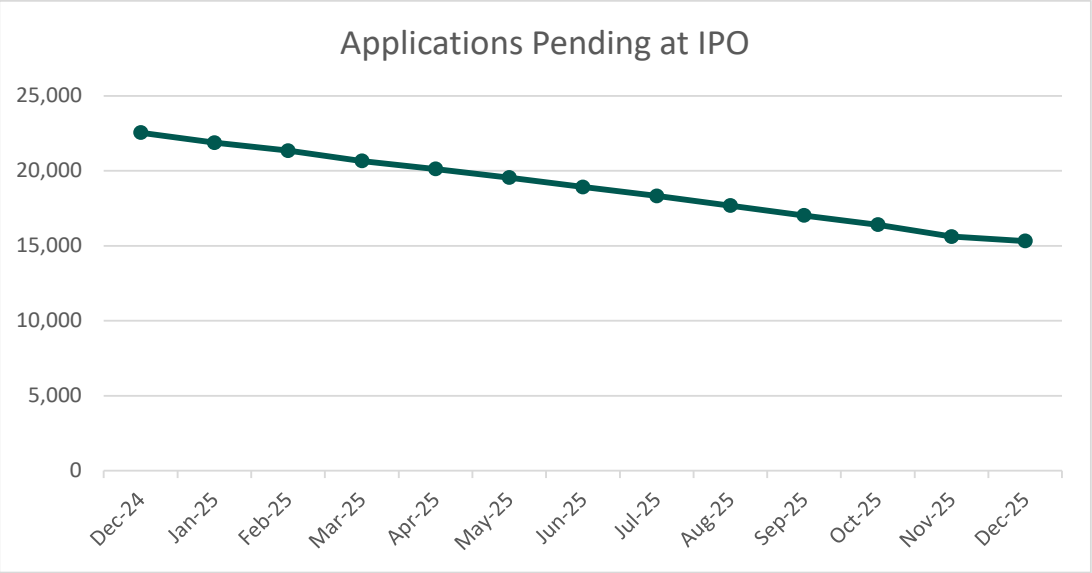
- Compared to last year, the number of asylum applications has dropped significantly. In December 2025 there were 1,256 applications compared to 1,024 in December 2024. However, looking at the full year comparison, the total number of applications has dropped from 18,553 in 2024 down to 13,162 in 2025, a reduction of 29%
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Somalia (2,021 applications), Nigeria (1,940), Pakistan (1,680), Afghanistan (1,292) and Georgia (925)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO has been reducing since the start of 2025, when it stood at 21,882. As of December this year, there were 15,315 applications pending
- Compared to last year, there has been an increase in the number of applications where the IPO made a recommendation or otherwise closed off a case. In December 2025, 1,518 cases were closed off compared to 1,102 in December 2024
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has been remaining steady in the last three months. In December 2025, the median processing time to determination was 75 weeks (compared to 71 weeks in June 2025 and 75 weeks in September 2025)
- The number of staff in the IPO remains steady at 614 at the end of December 2025
- Of those applications where a final decision was made in December 2025 (for example, after the outcomes of appeals were considered), 46% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 50% were international protection grants

Applications and Main Nationalities



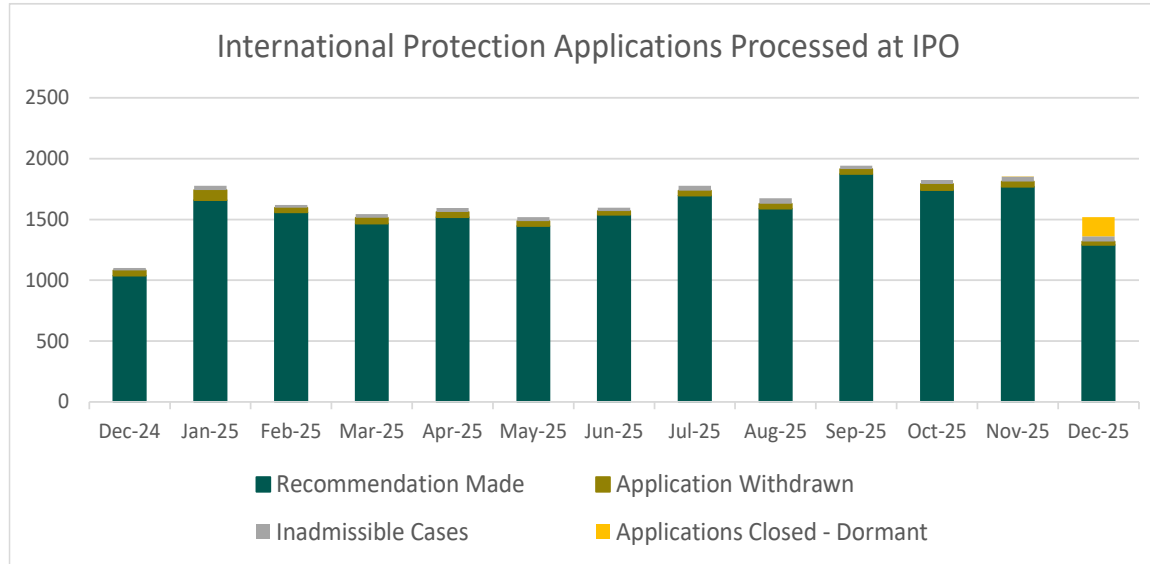
- In December 2025 there were 1,256 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,024 last December
- The total number of applications in December 2025 that fell under accelerated procedure was 548 (which represents 44% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2025 are: Somalia (2,021 applications), Nigeria (1,940), Pakistan (1,680), Afghanistan (1,292) and Georgia (925)

Pending International Protection Applications

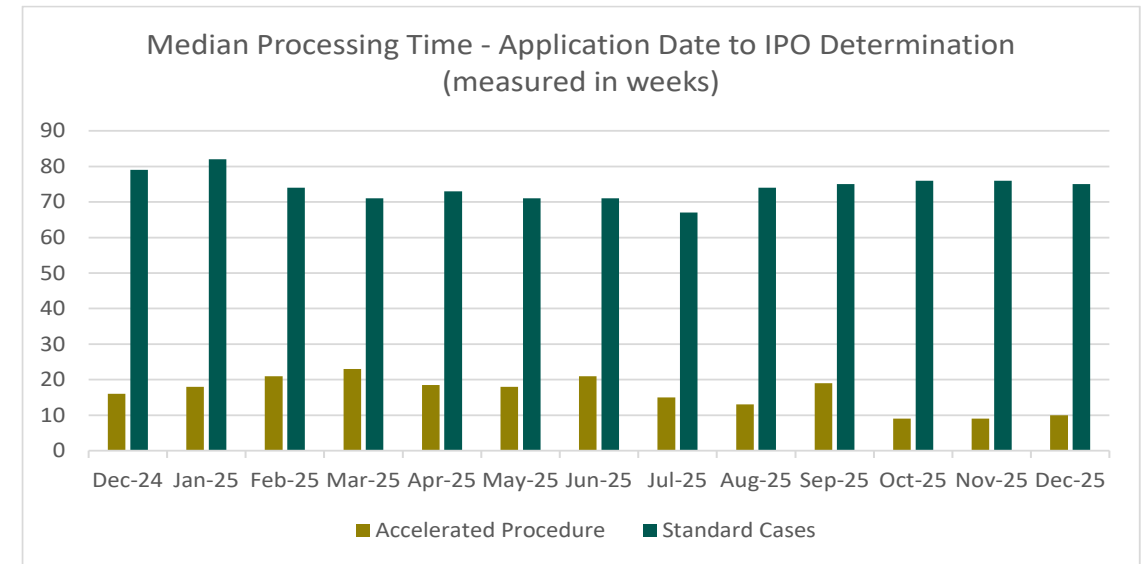


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 15,315. The numbers have been reducing since the end of September 2024
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards. In December 2025, there were 18,243 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of December 2025 is 85

International Protection: Applications Processed and Median Processing Time

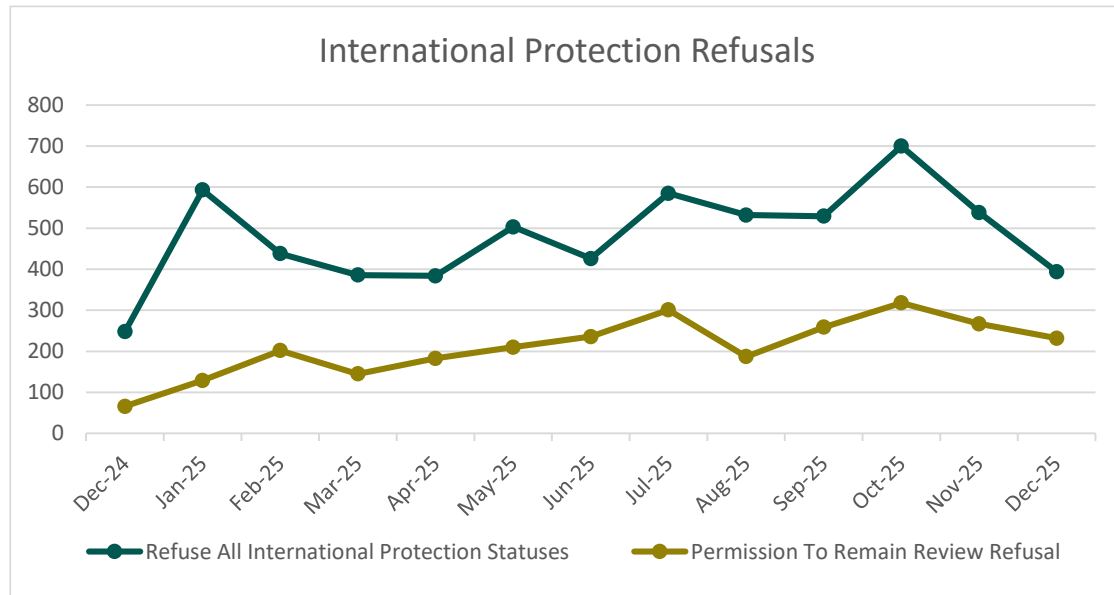
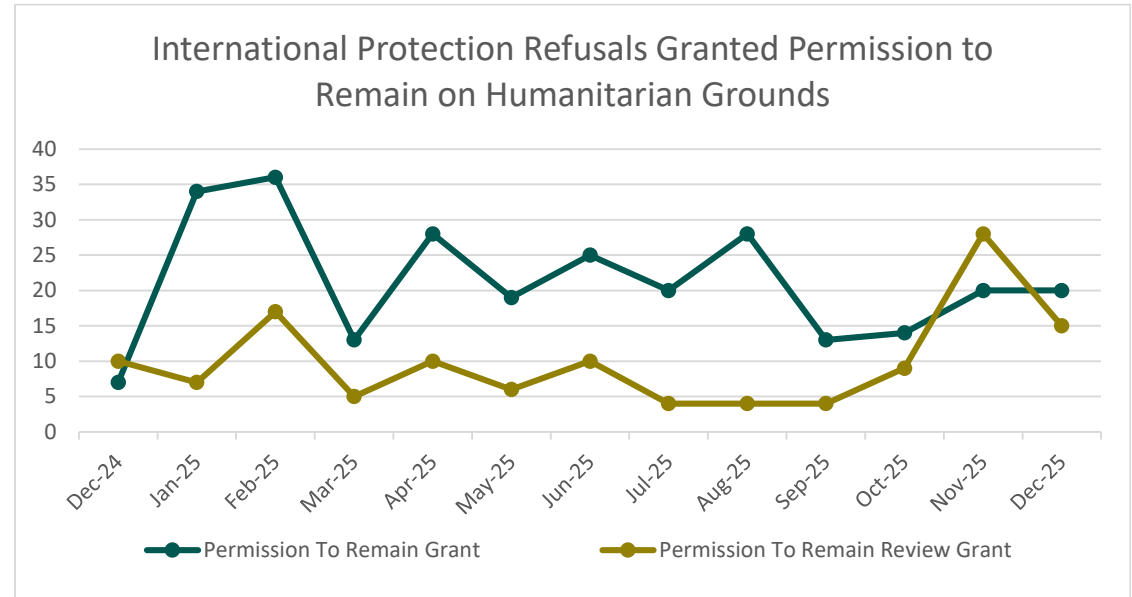
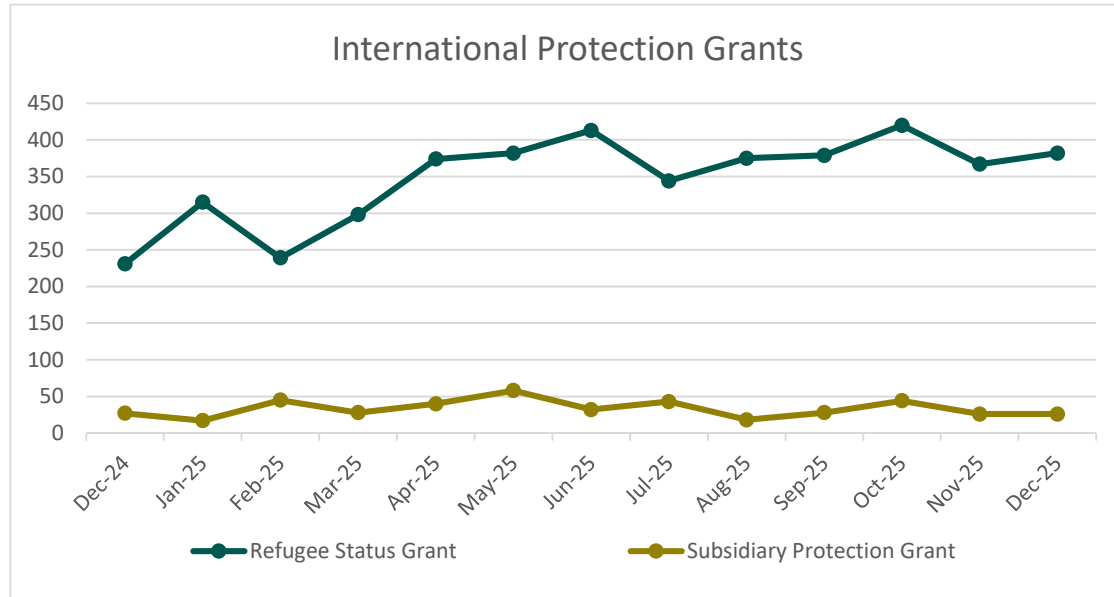


- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible, Applications Withdrawn and Dormant Applications
- In December 2025, 1,518 cases were closed off. This is down from 1,824 in October and down from 1,855 in November
- 2025 YTD applications processed were 20,240 (a 43.9% increase on 14,066 applications processed for 2024)



- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been remaining steady for Standard Cases. The median processing time for cases under the Accelerated Procedure have decreased compared to the first half of 2025.
- In December 2025, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 75 weeks (up from 71 weeks in June 2025 and the same as the 75 weeks in September 2025)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 10 weeks in December 2025, up from 9 weeks in October and up from 9 weeks in November

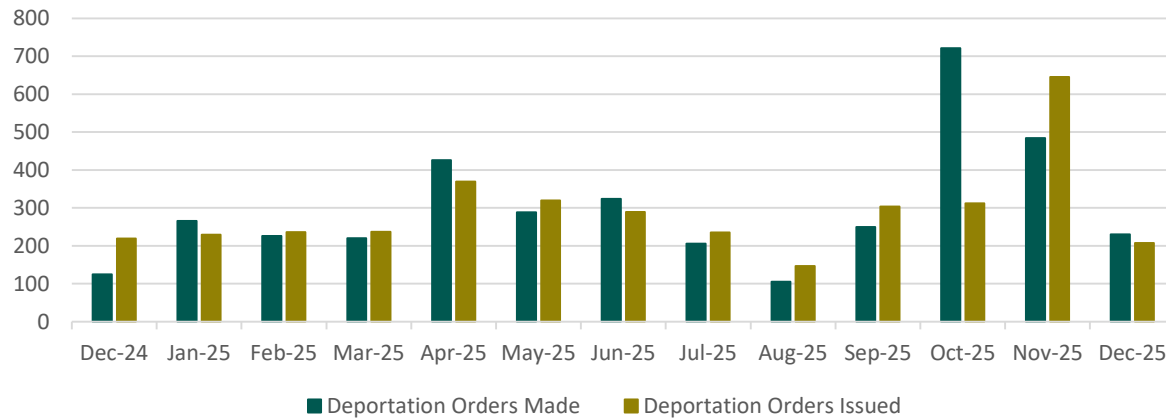
International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused



- In December 2025, of those applications where a final decision was made (for example, after taking into account appeals), 382 were given refugee status grant and 26 subsidiary protection grant (408 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 20 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 15 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 394 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 232 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall, for December 2025, 46% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 50% were international protection grants

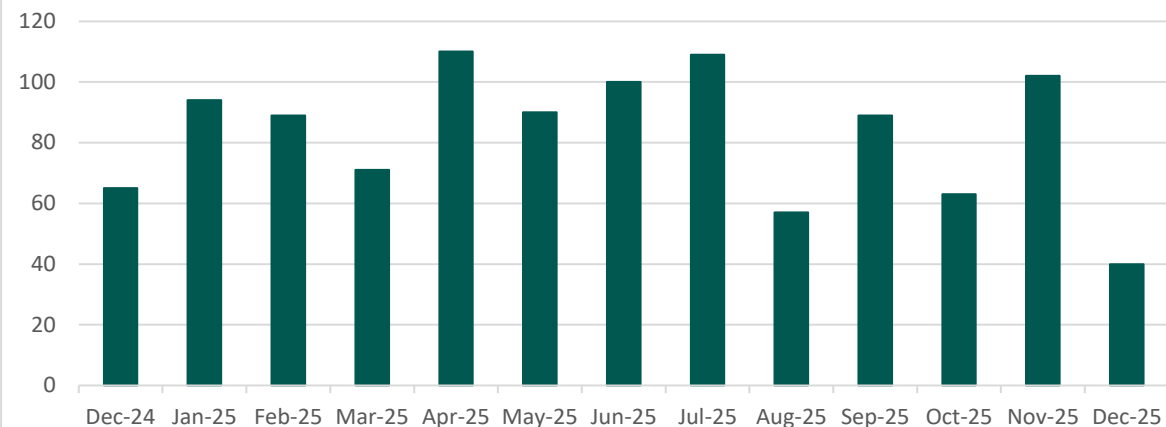
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

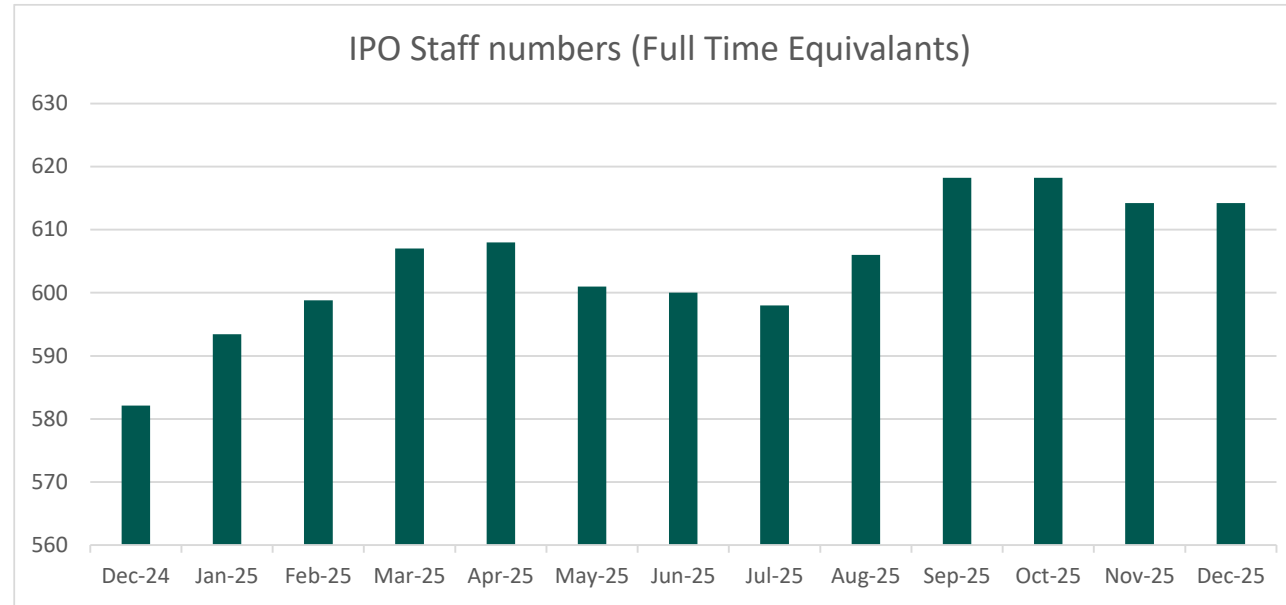


- For December 2025 the number of deportation orders made/signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 230 and the number of deportation orders issued was 207. For November, the figures were 484 and 645, and for October, the figures were 721 and 312, respectively
- For December 2025 the number of removals was 40

Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has started levelling off
- In December 2024 there were 582 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 618 in September and October 2025
- At the end of December 2025, the IPO had 614 FTE staff



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

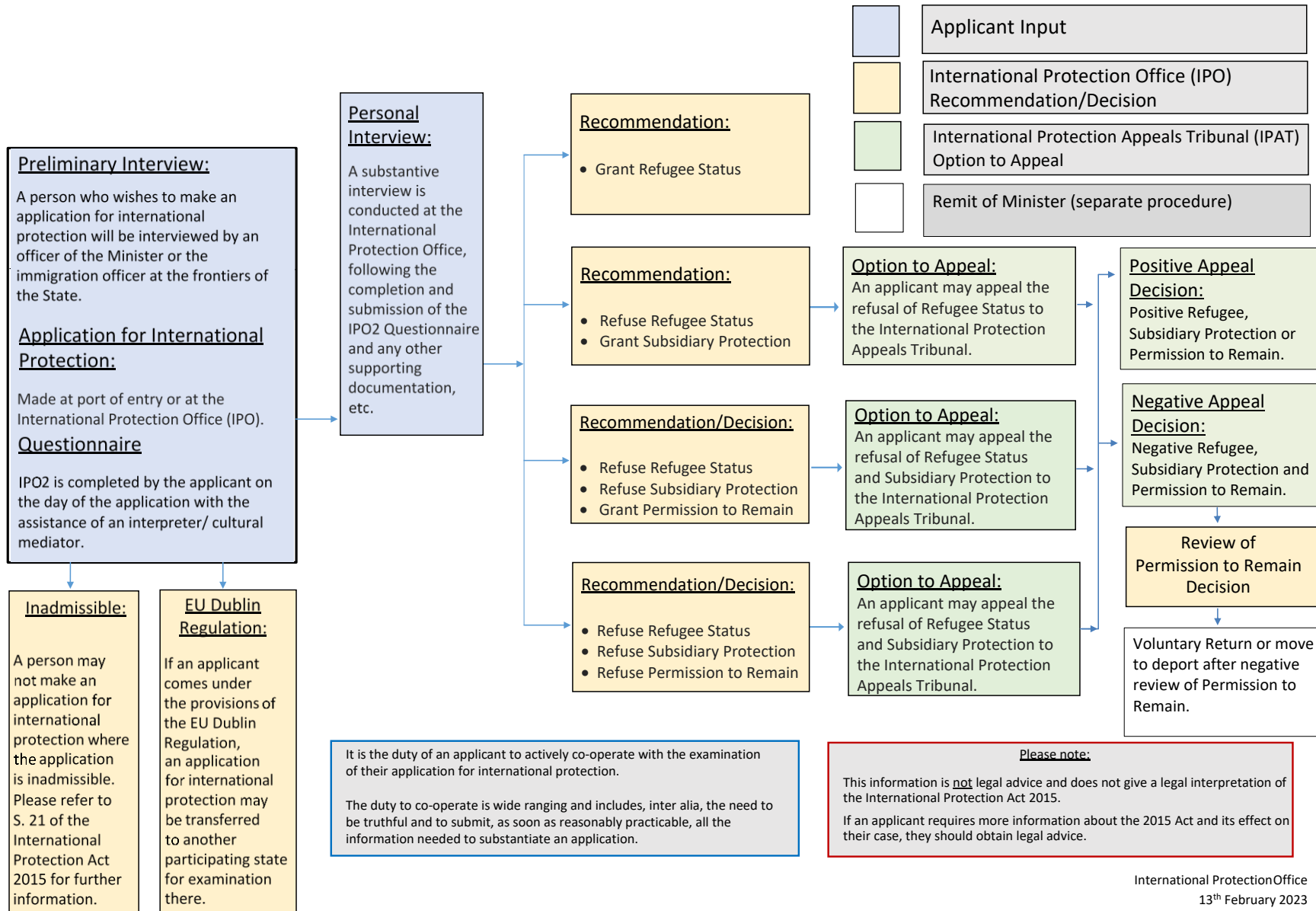
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Accelerated Procedure	377	351	347	263	327	333	285	344	440	589	519	400	548
Standard Cases	647	734	742	586	748	610	717	821	611	741	704	694	708

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2025	Applications	%
Somalia	2021	15.4%
Nigeria	1940	14.7%
Pakistan	1680	12.8%
Afghanistan	1292	9.8%
Georgia	925	7.0%
Other	5304	40.3%
Total	13162	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

IPO Pending	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
IP Pending	22,548	21,882	21,343	20,655	20,122	19,551	18,922	18,323	17,676	17,021	16,402	15,620	15,315
Leg Pending	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
IPAT Pending	9241	10123	11028	11814	12517	13393	14035	14529	15397	16067	16958	17579	18243

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

MDU Pending	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Total	141	191	186	216	168	123	95	119	101	152	73	68	85

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Recommendation Made	1039	1658	1558	1467	1519	1446	1539	1697	1588	1875	1742	1770	1290
Application Withdrawn	43	84	38	47	43	41	31	40	40	40	51	41	29
Inadmissible Cases	20	34	24	29	31	33	27	40	46	28	31	40	42
Applications Closed - Dormant	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	4	157

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Accelerated Procedure	16	18	21	23	18.5	18	21	15	13	19	9	9	10
Standard Cases	79	82	74	71	73	71	71	67	74	75	76	76	75

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Refugee Status Grant	231	315	239	298	374	382	413	344	375	379	420	367	382
Subsidiary Protection Grant	27	17	45	28	40	58	32	43	18	28	44	26	26
Permission to Remain Grant	7	34	36	13	28	19	25	20	28	13	14	20	20
Permission to Remain Review Grant	10	7	17	5	10	6	10	4	4	4	9	28	15

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	248	593	438	386	384	503	426	585	532	529	700	538	394
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	66	129	202	145	183	210	236	301	187	259	318	267	232

Data Tables (5)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Deportation Orders Made	125	266	226	220	426	288	324	206	105	250	721	484	230
Deportation Orders Issued	219	229	236	237	369	320	289	235	147	304	312	645	207

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

Enforcements/Returns*	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
Total	65	94	89	71	110	90	100	109	57	89	63	102	40

Data Tables (6)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Dec-24	Jan-25	Feb-25	Mar-25	Apr-25	May-25	Jun-25	Jul-25	Aug-25	Sep-25	Oct-25	Nov-25	Dec-25
IPO Staffing Levels	582.1	593.4	598.8	607	608	601	600	598	606	618.2	618.2	614.2	614.2